

INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 152 · HOT

Valar Atomics

Advanced Nuclear · Factory-Built Small Modular Reactors · El Segundo, California (reactor site: Emery County, Utah) · Private (\$6B reported; \$1B Series B, Aug 2026)

Valar Atomics, the El Segundo nuclear start-up whose Ward 250 reactor went critical in Utah in June and powered an NVIDIA Blackwell chip on 1 July, announced a \$1B Series B led by Sequoia on 3 August with a \$200M credit facility; Bloomberg puts the valuation at \$6B.

70

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

FE

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Andretti Formula E

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

The round is company-announced: \$1B of Series B equity led by Sequoia, whose Shaun Maguire joins the board, with Atreides, Point72, Snowpoint and Valor Equity Partners participating, plus a \$200M credit facility led by Erebor Bank with J.P. Morgan, Crescent Cove and Hercules Capital. Bloomberg and TechCrunch report a \$6B valuation, about three times the prior round; the company has not disclosed it. The engineering is real: Ward 250 reached criticality on 18 June at the Utah San Rafael Energy Lab under the DOE Reactor Pilot Program, the first DOE-authorized reactor built outside a national laboratory. The identity moment is public and presidential: on 1 July Ward 250 powered an NVIDIA Blackwell chip live on stage, the first US advanced reactor to run an AI chip, and the two companies announced a study for a 30 MW water-free AI facility in Utah. On 24 July Taylor stood in the Oval Office as one of four reactor CEOs the President honoured. A company selling firm power to hyperscalers needs a brand beyond the trade press.

WHY NOW

The round closed on 3 August and teams settle Season 13 rosters this autumn before the Jeddah opener on 18 December; the Austin E-Prix on 6 February and the Miami E-Prix on 20 February 2027 put two US rounds in front of the utilities, hyperscalers and regulators Valar sells to.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$1B

\$1B Series B led by Sequoia, company-announced 3 Aug 2026, with a \$200M credit facility led by Erebor Bank...

\$6B

Bloomberg puts the valuation at \$6B.

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE FE GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 10 OF 35 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

Andretti Formula E	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Envision Racing	TAKEN	Teijin
Citroën Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Cupra Kiro	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A company-announced \$1B Series B led by Sequoia, a DOE-recognised reactor and an Oval Office moment put Valar at peak brand-investment motive with an American story built for Andretti and an open energy lane in Formula E. The halo-only value and nuclear optics in an electric series hold the score at the 70 threshold.

FUNDING EVENT POLICY MILESTONE US MARKET DISCOVERY: SCAN

WHY ANDRETTI FORMULA E

Andretti is the American team in an electric championship, and its roster already carries TWG AI, an AI-infrastructure brand in the market Valar's reactors serve. The sponsor table shows no energy, fuel or power partner at Andretti and no nuclear or firm-power brand anywhere in Formula E, while TotalEnergies holds the energy lane at DS Penske, Shell at Lola Yamaha ABT and Castrol at Jaguar. An electric series asked where its power comes from meets an American reactor company with an answer.

VALUE TO ANDRETTI FORMULA E — MODE B (TECH SERVES THE TEAM OPERATION)

MODE B - halo with mechanics. A reactor is not a race-team input, and the brief says so. The value is commercial: Official Clean Firm Power Partner, an American energy story alongside TWG AI on the car, and Austin and Miami hospitality for utilities, hyperscalers, governors and federal officials no other Andretti partner brings. Valar gets a public stage; the team gets livery, content and a partner with \$1B to spend on being known.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official Clean Firm Power Partner. **THREE YEARS**, Seasons 13-15, spanning the Utah facility study and first commercial orders. Estimated \$1.5-2.5M a year. Scope: sidepod placement, Austin and Miami hospitality, a power-behind-the-grid content series, driver visits to Utah.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Isaiah Taylor

FOUNDER & CEO, VALAR ATOMICS · **VERIFIED**

Taylor founded Valar in El Segundo in July 2023 and is its public face, from the Oval Office to the Utah launch stage. Path: Muhammad Shahzad, President, formerly President and CFO of Relativity Space; Mark Mitchell, Chief Nuclear Officer. No chief marketing officer is listed.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the question the series cannot dodge.

“Isaiah, Formula E races on electricity and gets asked where it comes from; you just powered an NVIDIA chip from a reactor on stage. The American team has no power partner and races in Austin and Miami in February. 25 minutes?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 15 / 20 Round 3 Aug; off-season, but Season 13 rosters close before 18 Dec.	CAPACITY 16 / 20 \$1B equity plus \$200M credit; capital is for reactors, not marketing.	BRAND FIT 14 / 20 Deep-tech energy, profile-matched; nuclear optics in FE to manage.	URGENCY 13 / 20 Utah 30 MW study and first orders; no deal deadline.	OPS FIT 12 / 20 MODE B halo; lane open; reactor is not a race input.
---	---	---	---	---

RISKS & COUNTERS

SERIES OPTICS Formula E markets itself on sustainability; a fission brand may draw objection from the promoter, the team's owner or NGOs. **Counter:** Clear it with team and series early; frame as clean firm power for electrification.

PROOF OF CONCEPT ONLY Ward 250 ran at about 100 kW thermal for a demo; commercial power is years away, and the \$6B is Bloomberg's figure, not the company's. **Counter:** Anchor on the DOE milestone and the Oval Office; confirm the valuation on the first call.

SOURCES — 16 OF 16 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- https://www.deseret.com/business/2026/03/17/isaiah-taylor-who-founded-valar-atomics-is-bringing-nuclear-power-online/
- https://www.valaratomics.com/docs/Announcing-our-1B-Series-B-Led-By-Sequoia